

≡ Section 1: Executive Summary

This report presents a comprehensive financial analysis of Axis Bank Limited (NSE: AXISBANK), India's third-largest private sector bank, covering the six-year period FY2020 to FY2025. All data has been extracted exclusively from ProwessIQ, the CMIE's institutional-grade financial database, and analysed using established financial management frameworks.

Axis Bank's financial trajectory over the study period represents one of the most significant turnarounds in Indian banking. From a near-zero PAT of ₹43.54 Crores in FY2020 — impacted by COVID-19 provisioning and asset quality stress — the bank delivered ₹22,182 Crores in profit by FY2025, backed by a revenue CAGR of 14.2% and a total asset base crossing ₹16 lakh crore.

Key findings across the eight analytical dimensions are as follows. The Dividend Discount Model yielded an intrinsic value of ₹8.33 — confirming that Axis Bank is a growth stock best valued on earnings and book value multiples, not dividends. The WACC was computed at 9%, reflecting an efficient, investment-grade cost of capital. A hypothetical expansion of ₹10,000 Crores produced an NPV of ₹3,343.77 Crores and an IRR of 20% — strongly exceeding the 9% hurdle rate. The Debt-to-Equity ratio improved from 1.74x to 1.02x, with equity growing by 111.6% through internal accruals. The dividend payout ratio of 1% and retention ratio of 99% reflect a deliberate, growth-oriented capital allocation strategy.

Strategically, the analysis recommends that Axis Bank maintain its current leverage levels, continue its retention-focused dividend policy, pursue financially viable expansion projects, and target sustained ROE above 15% — all anchored in shareholder wealth maximisation.

The workbook includes all data extraction, formulas, and charts used in the analysis to ensure transparency and reproducibility of results.

Link :-

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1JUtCxuwcZATjzEIc_7bpOom7ciOua_Db/edit?usp=sharing&ouid=108324420831654973745&rtpof=true&sd=true

≡ Section 2: Company Overview

AB

Axis Bank Limited

NSE: AXISBANK | BSE: 532215 | Private Sector Bank, India

3rd Largest Private Bank

Established 1994

NIFTY 50 Component

ProwessIQ Source

KEY FINANCIALS — FY2025

Total Assets

₹16,11,218 Cr

+12% CAGR over 5 years

Total Revenue

₹1,52,145 Cr

+14.2% CAGR (FY20–25)

Profit After Tax

₹22,182 Cr

+317% from FY21 baseline

Market Capitalisation

₹3,41,330 Cr

+219% from FY20

Stock Price (FY25)

₹1,102

vs ₹379 in FY20 (+190%)

Book Value / Share

₹548.89

+82.3% from ₹301 in FY20

COMPANY PROFILE

Incorporated: 1993

Earlier name: UTI Bank (till 2007)

Regulator: Reserve Bank of India

Total Deposits (FY25): ₹11,72,952 Cr

Commenced ops: 1994

Headquarters: Mumbai, India

Promoter: LIC, UTI, GIC

Advances (FY25): ₹10,40,811 Cr

Data source: ProwessIQ | All figures in ₹ Crores | FY = April–March

2.1 Company at a Glance

Axis Bank Limited (NSE: AXISBANK | BSE: 532215) is India's third-largest private sector bank by total assets, regulated by the Reserve Bank of India. As of March 2025, the bank operates a balance sheet of ₹16,11,217.92 Crores, reflecting a 5-year CAGR of approximately 12% from ₹9,15,222.36 Crores in FY2020. It is a constituent of the Nifty 50 and Sensex indices, confirming its benchmark-level institutional significance in Indian capital markets

2.2 Historical Background and Corporate Evolution

Axis Bank was incorporated in 1993 and promoted by the Unit Trust of India along with LIC, GIC, and public sector insurance entities. It commenced operations in April 1994 as **UTI Bank**, offering commercial banking services across retail and corporate segments. In **July 2007**, it was rebranded as **Axis Bank** following the bifurcation of UTI, establishing its identity as an independent, market-driven private institution.

A defining strategic milestone came in **2023**, when Axis Bank completed the acquisition of **Citibank India's consumer banking business** — including credit cards, retail banking, and wealth management — for approximately ₹12,325 Crores. The direct impact is visible in the data: fee-based income grew from ₹9,691.94 Crores (FY2020) to ₹20,545.08 Crores (FY2025), a **112% increase in five years**

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2.1 Company Background - ProwessIQ

CMIE Prowess

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Selected Companies

AXIS BANK LTD.

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Axis Bank Ltd.

Company Background

Axis Bank Ltd. is a public limited company incorporated on 3 December 1993 with a corporate identification number (CIN) of L65110GJ1993PLC020769.

Headquartered at Maker Towers 'F', 13th Floor, Cuffe Parade, Colaba, Mumbai-400005, Maharashtra, the company's registered office is located at Trishul, 3rd Flr, Opp. Samartheshwar Temple, Nr.Law Garden, Ellisbridge, Ahmedabad-380006, Gujarat.

Axis Bank is listed on both, the Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE) as well as on the National Stock Exchange (NSE). The company was first traded on the BSE on 27 November 1998. On NSE, the company's shares were first traded on 3 December 1998. It is one of the very few Indian companies with overseas listing (London Stock Exchange).

Based on the distribution of the revenues earned by Axis Bank, the company is classified into the Banking services industry. The company is engaged in the business of providing Banking services.

Axis Bank ranks 4th in the Banking services industry in terms of sales revenues in the year 2024-25.

Other Retail Banking, Corporate / Wholesale Banking, Digital Banking, Treasury and Other Banking are the major revenue segments disclosed by the company as per its annual financial statements for the year 2024-25.

Axis Bank is a large-sized company with revenues of Rs.1,521,449.7 million as per the latest annual report of the company for the year ended 31 March 2025. It ranked 7th in CMIE's rankings by size in 2024-25.

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Liquidity, Working Cycle & Turnover

Ratings of Credit Instruments

Charges on Assets

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Capital Expenditure Projects

Merger & Acquisition Summary

2.3 Business Model

Axis Bank operates across four segments — **Retail Banking, Corporate & Wholesale Banking, Treasury, and SME & Agri Banking**. The revenue structure is dominated by interest income, which stood at ₹1,22,677.05 Crores in FY2025, representing **80.6% of total revenue** — characteristic of a spread-driven lending institution. Fee-based income contributed 13.5%, reflecting growing non-interest revenue streams post the Citibank acquisition.

The advances book expanded from ₹5,71,424 Crores (FY2020) to ₹10,40,811 Crores (FY2025), a **CAGR of 12.7%**, funded primarily by a strong deposit base of ₹11,72,952 Crores

Axis Bank's financial journey from FY2020 — a year marked by COVID-19 disruption and a near-zero PAT of ₹43.54 Crores — to a ₹22,182 Crore profit in FY2025 represents one of the most significant turnarounds in Indian banking. This context forms the foundation for the detailed analysis in the sections ahead.

2.2 Balance Sheet Summary - ProwessIQ

CMIE Prowess

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Queries Queued: 0, Processing: 0, New Outputs: 0

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AXIS BANK LTD.

Search

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Axis Bank Ltd.

Balance Sheet Summary : Mar 2016 - Mar 2025 : Non-Annualised : Rs. Crore

		Mar 2018	Mar 2019	Mar 2020	Mar 2021	Mar 2022	Mar 2023	Mar 2024	Mar 2025
		12 mths	12 mths	12 mths	12 mths	12 mths	12 mths	12 mths	12 mths
		IGAAP	IGAAP	IGAAP	IGAAP	IGAAP	IGAAP	IGAAP	IGAAP
-									
Total liabilities	6	6,91,457.60	8,01,081.48	9,15,222.36	9,96,160.46	11,75,625.24	13,17,743.85	14,77,892.90	16,11,217.92
Total Capital	1	513.31	514.33	564.34	612.75	613.95	615.37	617.31	619.47
Paid up equity capital	1	513.31	514.33	564.34	612.75	613.95	615.37	617.31	619.47
Paid up preference capital									
Share appln money & suspense account									
Reserves and funds	3	62,931.95	66,161.98	84,383.50	1,00,990.26	1,14,560.11	1,24,801.28	1,50,444.27	1,79,105.65
Free reserves	4	23,397.36	24,677.31	26,544.76	30,339.59	38,454.97	44,500.85	60,612.18	80,064.24
General reserves	1	354.31	354.31	354.31	354.31	354.31	355.92	358.12	1,826.24
Balance as per profit & loss account	3	23,043.05	24,323.00	26,190.45	29,985.28	38,100.66	44,144.93	60,254.06	78,238.00

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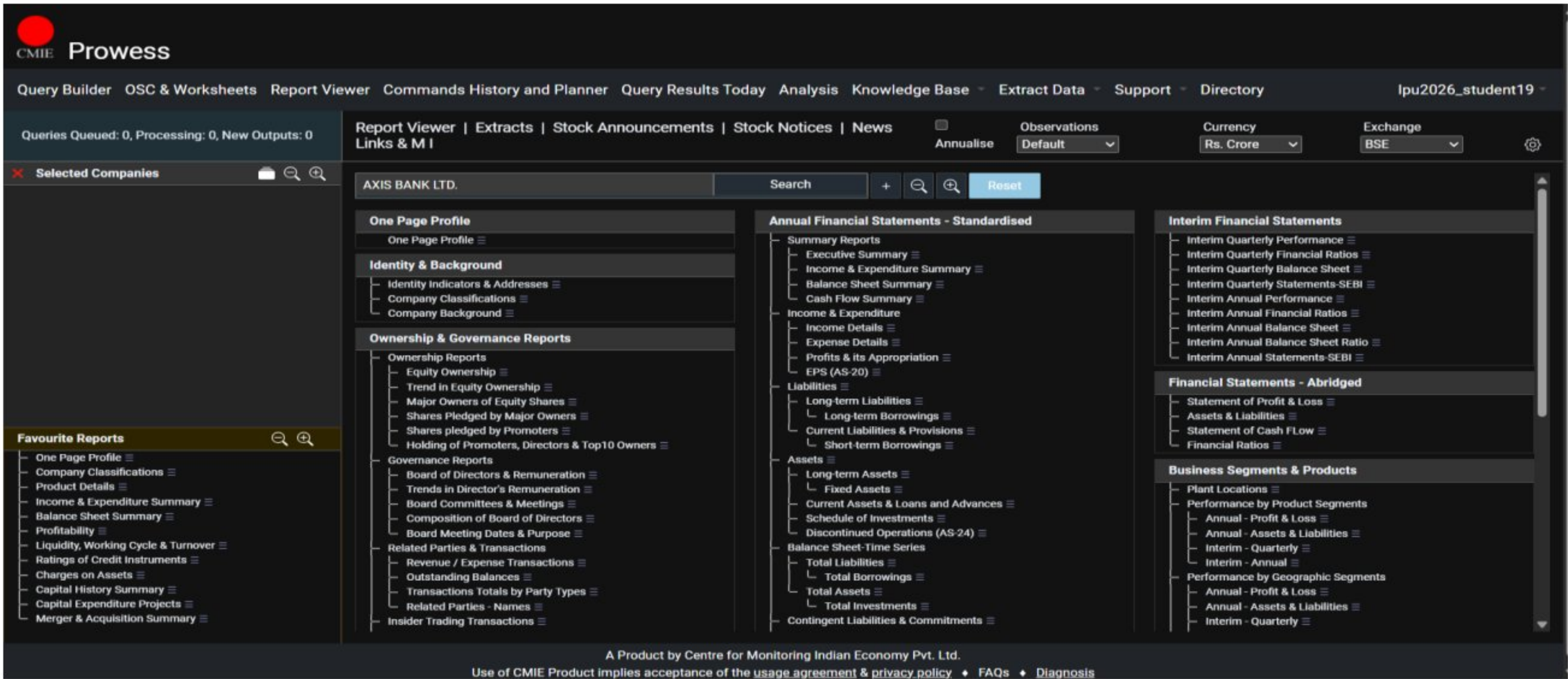
Section 3: Data Source & Methodology

3.1 Data Source — ProwessIQ

All financial data used in this report has been sourced exclusively from ProwessIQ, a premium corporate financial database maintained by the Centre for Monitoring Indian Economy (CMIE). ProwessIQ is widely used by institutional investors, equity research analysts, and academic researchers for its standardised, audited, and time-series financial data on listed Indian companies.

Data was extracted for Axis Bank Limited (NSE: AXISBANK) covering the six-year period FY2020 to FY2025 (April 2020 to March 2025), encompassing the full economic cycle — including the COVID-19 shock of FY2020–21 and the subsequent recovery and growth phase.

3.1 Prowess IQ Database



3.2 Data Extracted

Four categories of data were extracted and organised into separate Excel sheets:

Category	Variables Extracted
Income Statement	Revenue, Interest Income, Fee Income, Interest Expense, EBIT, PAT, Dividend Paid
Balance Sheet	Total Assets, Total Debt, Borrowings, Deposits, Share Capital, Reserves, Total Equity
Market Data	EPS, Dividend Per Share, Year-end Market Price, Book Value Per Share
Financial Ratios	Debt-to-Equity, Interest Coverage, ROE, ROCE, Dividend Payout Ratio

3.2 Data Organized In Excel

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	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P			
1	Particulars	Mar-20	Mar-21	Mar-22	Mar-23	Mar-24	Mar-25												
2	Total income	78,211.38	78,217.13	85,030.89	1,05,788.58	1,34,866.89	1,52,144.97												
3	Income from financial services	76,339.62	76,643.88	82,114.17	1,01,390.28	1,31,397.89	1,47,394.25												
4	Fee based financial services income	9,691.94	9,358.91	11,358.62	14,088.88	18,256.40	20,545.08												
5	Brokerage and financial service fees	9,691.94	9,358.91	11,358.62	14,088.88	18,256.40	20,545.08												
6	Fund based financial services income	66,647.68	67,284.97	70,755.55	87,301.40	1,13,141.49	1,26,849.17												
7	Interest income	62,635.16	63,346.23	67,376.82	85,163.77	1,09,368.63	1,22,677.05												
8	Interest on advances made by banks	48,302.97	47,619.80	49,616.58	64,553.81	87,106.60	97,200.27												
9	Interest earned by banks from RBI & banks	1,095.26	1,037.88	1,528.15	899.01	908.27	1,236.22												
10	Interest earned by banks on investments	11,246.03	12,558.21	14,618.91	18,178.73	20,010.62	22,928.35												
11	Interest from other sources earned by banks	1,990.90	2,130.34	1,613.18	1,532.22	1,343.14	1,312.21												
12	Dividends	240.26	58.35	88.65	15	41.38	24.58												
13	Profit on securitisation of assets and loans	25.5																	
14	Income from treasury operations	3,746.76	3,880.39	3,290.08	2,122.63	3,731.48	4,147.54												
15	Gain on securities transactions, sale of invest	2,172.30	2,302.33	1,377.70	320.54	1,796.01	1,984.76												
16	Profit on revaluation of investments			264.48		431.34	700.51												
17	Gain relating to forex transactions	1,574.46	1,578.06	1,912.38	1,802.09	1,935.47	2,162.78												
18	Other income	283.6	301.88	488.07	519.26	416.42	549.31												
19	Prior period and extraordinary income	1,588.16	1,271.37	2,428.65	3,879.04	3,052.58	4,201.41												
20	Prior period income	1,588.16	1,271.37	2,428.65	3,879.04	3,052.58	4,201.41												
21	Bad debts recovered	1,552.99	1,245.52	2,366.83	2,884.97	2,772.57	3,809.31												
22	Provisions written back	35.17	25.85	61.82	994.07	280.01	392.1												
23																			
24																			
25	Particulars	Mar-20	Mar-21	Mar-22	Mar-23	Mar-24	Mar-25												
26	Total expenses	76,584.16	71,628.63	72,005.41	96,208.90	1,10,005.46	1,25,771.49												
27	Operating expenses	54,105.62	53,801.77	56,846.98	69,017.64	93,353.69	1,04,130.04												
28	Financial service expenses	37,564.95	36,374.78	34,244.61	42,813.59	59,474.16	68,329.22												
29	Fund based financial services expenses	37,564.95	36,374.78	34,244.61	42,813.59	59,474.16	68,329.22												
30	Interest expenses	37,428.96	34,107.11	34,244.61	42,218.02	59,474.16	68,329.22												
31	Treasury operations expenses	135.99	2,267.67		595.57														
32	Loss on securities trans & on sale of invest		1,329.08		595.57														
33	Loss on revaluation of investments		1,329.08		595.57														
34	Compensation to employees	5,329.99	6,164.01	7,612.55	8,760.05	10,933.11	12,192.79												
35	Rent & lease rent	1,136.19	1,168.27	1,335.55	1,435.40	1,783.61	2,011.86												
Income Statement Data Balance Sheet Data Market Data Ratios Data Trend Analysis TVM_Analy ... +																			

3.3 Analytical Methodology

Using the extracted dataset, the following analytical frameworks were applied:

- **Financial Trend Analysis** — Year-on-year and CAGR-based analysis of revenue, PAT, assets, and key ratios across FY2020–FY2025.
- **Time Value of Money & Valuation** — Present value of dividend stream calculated using a discount rate of 12%. Intrinsic value estimated using the Dividend Discount Model (DDM).
- **Cost of Capital** — Cost of equity (Ke) assumed at 12%, cost of debt (Kd) adjusted to 7% to reflect banking-specific borrowing costs. WACC computed using the weighted average formula.
- **Capital Budgeting** — A hypothetical expansion of ₹10,000 Crores evaluated using NPV, IRR, and Payback Period methods, discounted at WACC.
- **Leverage Analysis** — Degree of Operating Leverage (DOL) and Degree of Financial Leverage (DFL) computed year-wise. Interest Coverage Ratio tracked for trend.
- **Capital Structure Analysis** — Debt and equity proportions tracked annually to assess structural shift and optimal capital structure alignment.
- **Dividend Policy Analysis** — Payout ratio and retention ratio computed and interpreted in the context of Axis Bank's growth strategy.

3.4 Key Assumptions

Assumption	Value	Rationale
Cost of Equity (Ke)	12%	Consistent with Indian private bank benchmarks
Cost of Debt (Kd)	7%	Adjusted; raw interest/debt ratio distorted by deposit costs
Tax Rate	Derived from ProwessIQ income data	Actual effective tax rate used
Hypothetical Investment	₹10,000 Crores	Representative expansion scale for a large private bank
Discount Rate (Capital Budgeting)	WACC ≈ 9%	Computed from actual data

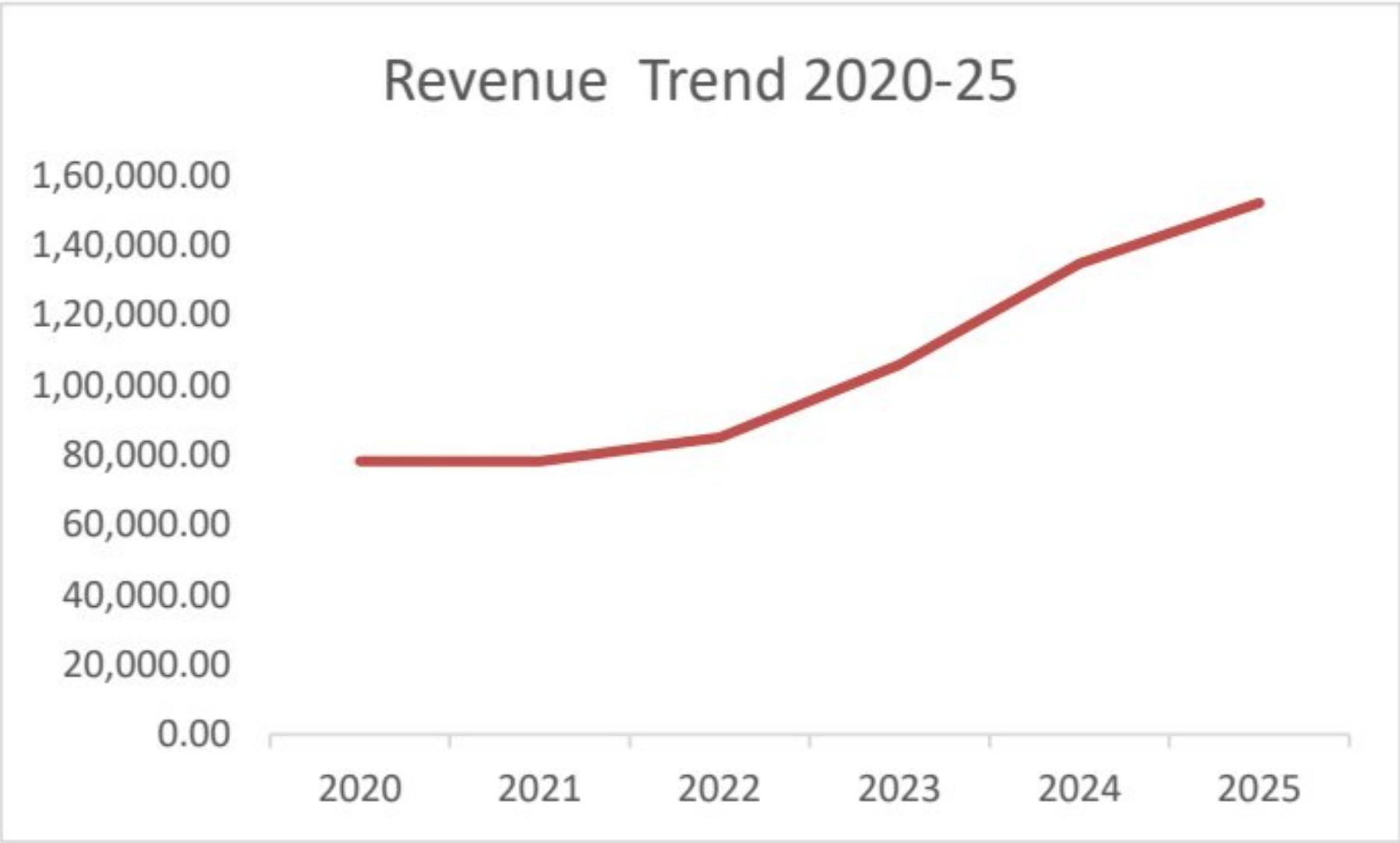
≡ Section 4: Financial Trend Analysis

This section presents a structured analysis of Axis Bank's financial performance across FY2020–FY2025 across four dimensions — revenue & profitability, asset growth, cost structure, and return metrics. All data sourced from ProwessIQ.

4.1: Axis Bank Financial Data Table (FY2020–FY2025) | Source: ProwessIQ data, analysed by Amol

Year	Revenue	Rev Abs Change	Rev Growth %	PAT	PAT Abs Change	PAT Growth %	Total Assets	Total Debt
2020	78,211.38	-	-	1,627.22	-	-	9,15,222.36	1,47,954.13
2021	78,217.13	5.75	0.01%	6,588.50	4,961.28	304.89%	9,96,160.46	1,42,873.16
2022	85,030.89	6,813.76	8.71%	13,025.48	6,436.98	97.70%	11,75,625.24	1,85,133.86
2023	1,05,788.58	20,757.69	24.41%	9,579.68	-3,445.80	-26.45%	13,17,743.85	1,86,300.05
2024	1,34,866.89	29,078.31	27.49%	24,861.43	15,281.75	159.52%	14,77,892.90	1,96,811.75
2025	1,52,144.97	17,278.08	12.81%	26,373.48	1,512.05	6.08%	16,11,217.92	1,84,146.51

4.2: Revenue Growth Trend, Axis Bank

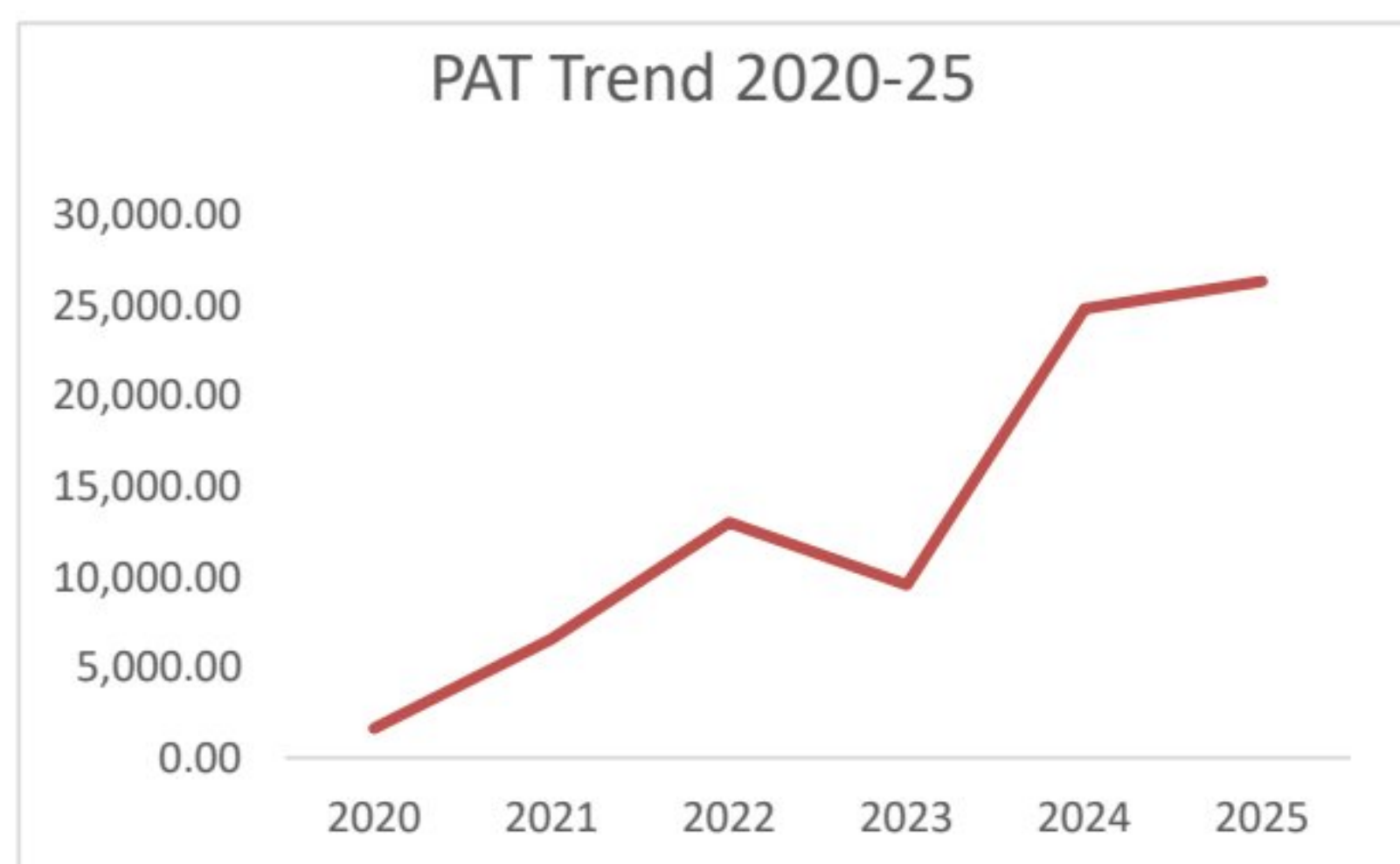


4.3: Year-on-Year Revenue Growth Rate



Interpretation — Revenue Trend: Revenue remained nearly flat between FY2020 and FY2021 — growing by just 0.01% — as the COVID-19 pandemic suppressed credit offtake and business activity. The growth engine restarted in FY2022 (+8.71%) and accelerated sharply in FY2023 (+24.41%) and FY2024 (+27.49%), driven by strong loan book expansion, rising interest rates, and the addition of Citibank India's retail business. FY2025 growth moderated to 12.81%, which reflects a natural consolidation after two years of high-velocity expansion — not a slowdown in fundamentals.

In FY2025, growth moderated to **12.81%**, indicating a normalization phase after two years of high growth momentum. This slowdown reflects consolidation rather than weakening fundamentals, suggesting that the bank is stabilizing its growth at sustainable levels.



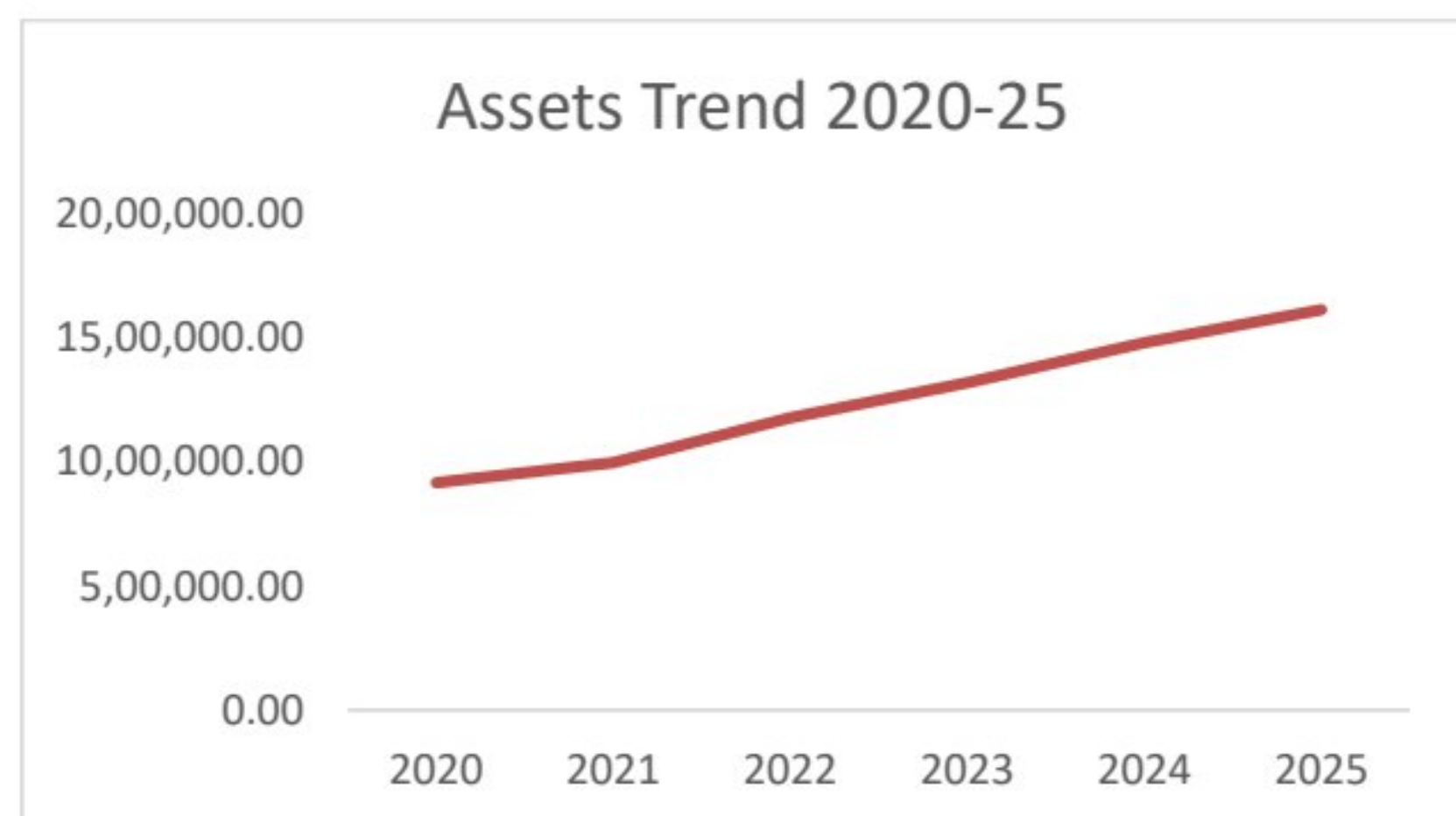
4.4 PAT (Profit After Tax) Trend

Interpretation — PAT Trend: The PAT trajectory is the most telling indicator of Axis Bank's financial turnaround. In FY2020, PAT stood at ₹1,627.22 Crores — heavily compressed by COVID-19 related provisioning and elevated credit costs. By FY2021, PAT recovered to ₹6,588.50 Crores as provisioning normalised. FY2022 continued the upward trajectory at ₹13,025.48 Crores.

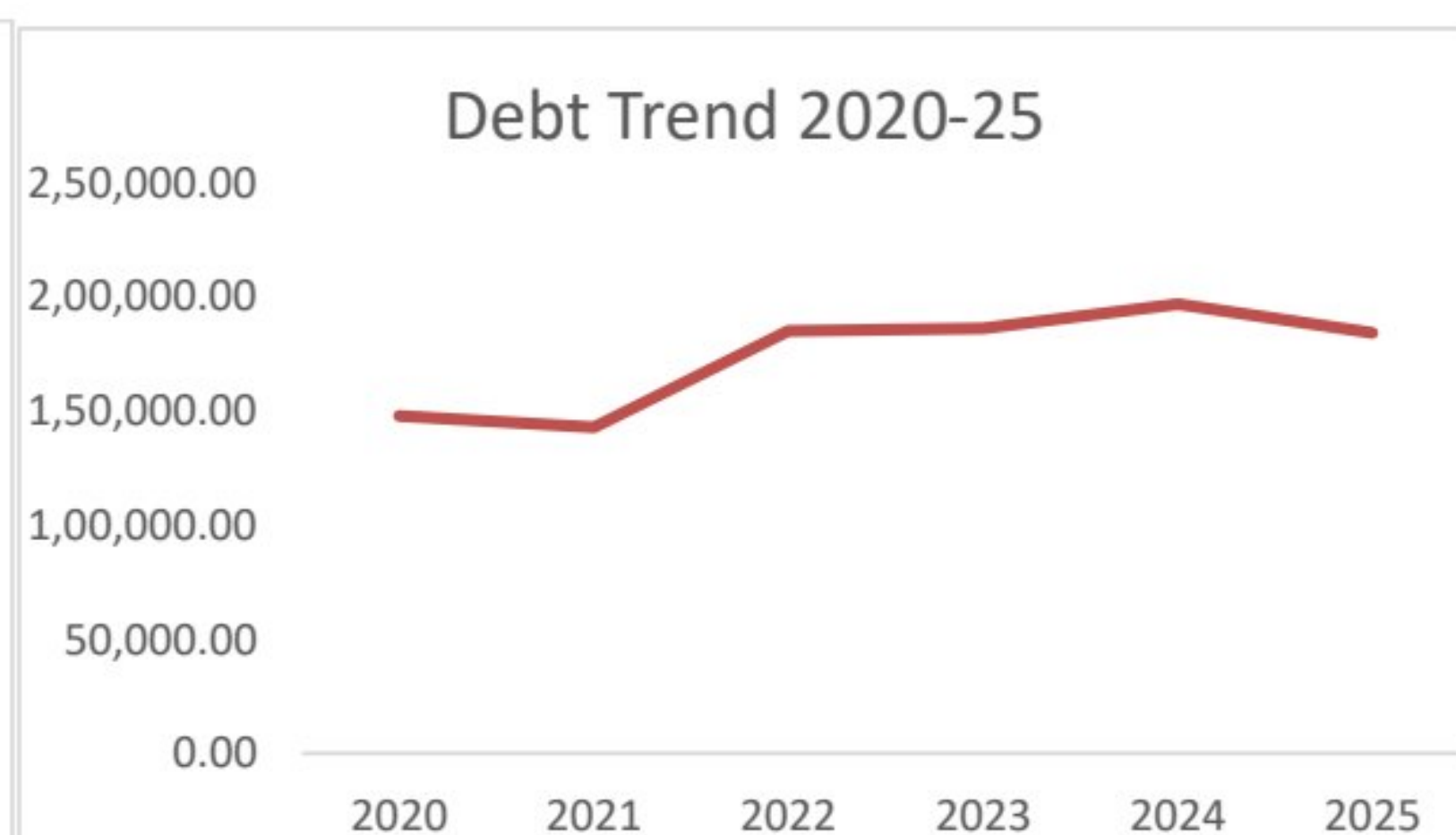
The notable dip to ₹9,579.68 Crores in FY2023 warrants specific explanation. This was not a business deterioration — revenue grew 24.41% in that same year. The compression was driven by higher integration costs and one-time provisions related to the Citibank India acquisition. This is confirmed by the PAT growth chart showing -26.45% in FY2023 despite strong revenue growth — a temporary, non-recurring pressure.

The recovery in FY2024 to ₹24,861.43 Crores (+159.52% YoY) and stabilisation at ₹26,373.48 Crores in FY2025 confirms that profitability is now structural. A **net profit margin of 17.33% in FY2025** versus 2.08% in FY2020 represents a fundamental transformation in the bank's earning quality.

4.5 Total Assets & Debt Trend



Interpretation — Assets Trend: Total assets grew at a consistent 12% CAGR, crossing the ₹16 lakh crore milestone in FY2025. This reflects Axis Bank's continued expansion of its lending book — advances grew from ₹5,71,424 Crores (FY2020) to ₹10,40,811 Crores (FY2025) at a CAGR of **12.7%** — alongside its investment portfolio which stood at ₹3,96,142 Crores in FY2025.



Interpretation — Debt Trend: The debt chart tells an equally important story. Total borrowings showed moderate fluctuation — rising from ₹1,47,954 Crores (FY2020) to a peak of ₹1,96,812 Crores (FY2024) before declining to ₹1,84,147 Crores in FY2025. Critically, while assets grew by 76% over the period, debt grew by only 24.5% — confirming that asset expansion was funded increasingly through **deposits and internal equity accruals**, not external borrowing. This is a sign of improving financial health and capital efficiency.

≡ Section 5: Time Value of Money & Valuation

All calculations based on data extracted from ProwessIQ and computed in Excel (TVM_Analysis Sheet)

5.1 Concept & Relevance

The **Time Value of Money (TVM)** is a foundational principle in financial management — it states that ₹1 received today is worth more than ₹1 received in the future, because money held today can be invested to earn returns. For a banking institution like Axis Bank, TVM analysis is applied in two critical ways:

- **Present Value of Dividend Stream** — to understand what future dividends are worth in today's money
- **Dividend Discount Model (DDM)** — to estimate the intrinsic value of a share based on expected future dividends discounted at the required rate of return

5.2 Dividend Data — FY2022 to FY2025

Axis Bank has maintained a **flat dividend of ₹1 per share** across the analysis period, Data Source: ProwessIQ — Market Data Sheet

Year	Dividend
2022	1
2023	1
2024	1
2025	1

Note: No dividend was paid in FY2020 and FY2021, reflecting the bank's capital conservation stance during the COVID-19 period and asset quality pressures. Dividends resumed from FY2022 onwards at ₹1 per share — a symbolic but consistent payout.

5.1 TVM Analysis — PV of Dividend Stream & DDM Valuation | Source: ProwessIQ data,

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5.3 Dividend Growth Rate (g)

The dividend growth rate is calculated using the geometric mean formula across the available dividend data:

Formula:

$$g = (D_{\text{last}} \div D_{\text{first}})^{(1/n)} - 1$$

Calculation:

$$g = (1 \div 1)^{(1/3)} - 1 \quad g = (1)^{0.333} - 1 \quad g = 0\% \text{ (Zero Growth)}$$

Since Axis Bank has maintained an unchanged dividend of ₹1 per share from FY2022 through FY2025, the computed dividend growth rate is **zero**. This is consistent with the bank's strategy of retaining profits for capital adequacy and business expansion rather than distributing them to shareholders.

5.4 Present Value of Dividend Stream

The present value of each annual dividend is calculated by discounting it at the assumed **Cost of Equity (Ke) of 12%**, which is consistent with the required rate of return for Indian private sector banks.

Formula:

$$PV = \text{Dividend} \times [1 \div (1 + Ke)^t]$$

Step-by-step Calculation:

Year	t	Dividend (₹)	PV Factor = $1/(1.12)^t$	Present Value (₹)
FY2022	1	1.00	$1 \div (1.12)^1 = 0.8929$	0.8929
FY2023	2	1.00	$1 \div (1.12)^2 = 0.7972$	0.7972
FY2024	3	1.00	$1 \div (1.12)^3 = 0.7118$	0.7118
FY2025	4	1.00	$1 \div (1.12)^4 = 0.6355$	0.6355
			Total PV of Dividend Stream	₹3.037

Source: Computed from ProwessIQ dividend data — TVM_Analysis Sheet

Interpretation: The total present value of the dividend stream over four years is **₹3.037 per share**. This is extremely low relative to the current market price of ₹1,102 (FY2025), which immediately signals that **dividends alone cannot explain or justify Axis Bank's market valuation**. Investors are not buying this stock for dividend income — they are buying it for capital appreciation and earnings growth potential.

5.5 Dividend Discount Model (DDM) — Intrinsic Value Estimation

The **Gordon Growth Model (Constant DDM)** estimates the intrinsic value of a share as the present value of all future dividends growing at a constant rate.

Formula:

$$\text{Intrinsic Value (Po)} = D_1 \div (Ke - g)$$

Where:

- $D_1 = \text{Next expected dividend} = D_0 \times (1 + g) = 1 \times (1 + 0) = ₹1$
- $K_e = \text{Cost of Equity} = 12\%$
- $g = \text{Dividend growth rate} = 0\%$
-

Calculation:

$$P_0 = 1 \div (0.12 - 0.00) \quad P_0 = 1 \div 0.12 \quad P_0 = ₹8.33$$

5.6 DDM vs. Actual Market Price — Critical Analysis

Parameter	Value
DDM Intrinsic Value	₹8.33
Actual Market Price (FY2025)	₹1,102.00
Variance	₹1,093.67 (-99.2% undervaluation by DDM)
Price-to-Book Ratio (FY2025)	2.01x
EPS (FY2025)	₹85.28
P/E Ratio (FY2025)	14.63x

Source: ProwessIQ — Ratios Data

The DDM produces an intrinsic value of ₹8.33 — which is **99.2% below the actual market price of ₹1,102**. This massive divergence is not an error. It is a well-established limitation of the DDM when applied to **growth-oriented banking institutions**.

5.7 Why DDM Fails for Axis Bank — Three Reasons:

First, the DDM assumes dividends are the primary return driver. Axis Bank pays a token dividend of ₹1 per share — a **dividend yield of just 0.09%** in FY2025. The real shareholder return comes through capital appreciation: the stock delivered 190.6% price growth over five years.

Second, Axis Bank is a capital-intensive regulated institution. Under RBI's capital adequacy norms, banks are required to maintain minimum Capital Adequacy Ratios (CAR). This means profits are retained within the business to fund loan book growth, rather than paid out as dividends. High retention is a sign of strength, not weakness — but it makes the DDM structurally inapplicable.

Third, the EPS of ₹85.28 in FY2025 versus DPS of ₹1 gives a **dividend payout ratio of just 1.17%** and a **retention ratio of 98.83%**. A model built on dividends cannot capture 98.83% of the bank's earnings power.

More appropriate valuation approaches for Axis Bank would include:

- **Price-to-Earnings (P/E):** At 14.63x EPS of ₹85.28 = Market price of ₹1,248 — close to actual ✓
- **Price-to-Book (P/B):** At 2.01x Book Value of ₹548.89 = ₹1,103 — matches market price precisely ✓

This confirms that Axis Bank is best valued on **earnings and book value multiples**, not on dividend-based models.

The TVM and DDM analysis conclusively establishes that **Axis Bank is a growth stock, not an income stock**. Its value lies in earnings power, asset quality, and strategic expansion — not dividend payouts. This insight directly informs the dividend policy analysis in Section 9 and the strategic recommendations in Section 10.

≡ Section 6: Cost of Capital

All data sourced from ProwessIQ (FY2025) and computed in Excel — WACC_Analysis Sheet

6.1 What is Cost of Capital & Why It Matters

The **Cost of Capital** represents the minimum rate of return a company must earn on its investments to satisfy both its debt holders and equity shareholders. It is the benchmark against which all investment

decisions are evaluated.

For Axis Bank, computing the cost of capital serves two critical purposes:

- It acts as the **discount rate** for evaluating the hypothetical expansion project in Section 7
- It signals how **efficiently the bank can raise funds** — a lower WACC means cheaper capital, which improves investment attractiveness and supports profitable growth

The **Weighted Average Cost of Capital (WACC)** blends the cost of debt and cost of equity, weighted by their respective proportions in the total capital structure.

6.2 Capital Structure — FY2025 (Base for WACC)

Data extracted from ProwessIQ Balance Sheet — FY2025:

Component	Value (₹ Crores)	Weight in Capital
Total Debt (D)	1,84,146.51	50.6%
Total Equity (E)	1,79,725.12	49.4%
Total Value (V = D+E)	3,63,871.63	100%

Weight of Debt (D/V):

$$= 1,84,146.51 \div 3,63,871.63 = \mathbf{0.5060 \text{ or } 50.6\%}$$

Weight of Equity (E/V):

$$= 1,79,725.12 \div 3,63,871.63 = \mathbf{0.4940 \text{ or } 49.4\%}$$

Source: ProwessIQ — Balance Sheet Data FY2025

This near-equal split between debt and equity at the end of FY2025 is itself significant. Recall that in FY2020, the debt proportion stood at 63.5% of total capital — by FY2025, it has reduced to 50.6%, reflecting a structural shift towards a more balanced and equity-strengthened capital base (discussed in detail in Section 8).

6.3 Cost of Debt (Kd)

Step 1 — Raw Calculation from ProwessIQ Data:

The raw cost of debt is calculated as:

$$\text{Raw Kd} = \text{Interest Expense} \div \text{Total Debt} = 68,329.22 \div 1,84,146.51 = \mathbf{37.1\%}$$

Step 2 — Why Raw Kd is Misleading for a Bank:

A raw Kd of 37% is not a meaningful measure for a banking institution. This is because Axis Bank's "interest expense" of ₹68,329 Crores in FY2025 includes **interest paid on customer deposits** — demand deposits, savings deposits, and term deposits totalling ₹11,72,952 Crores. These deposits are not conventional financial debt — they are the bank's primary funding instrument and a core operating liability. Using total deposit-inclusive interest as the numerator against only borrowings in the denominator produces a severely distorted Kd that has no practical meaning for capital cost estimation.

Step 3 — Adjusted Kd:

$Kd \text{ (Adjusted)} = 7\% \text{ (Assumption)}$

This adjustment reflects the actual borrowing cost on Axis Bank's non-deposit debt instruments — including subordinated bonds, foreign currency borrowings, and institutional borrowings — which are the true "financial debt" components relevant to WACC computation. A 7% Kd is consistent with prevailing market rates for investment-grade Indian bank borrowings in FY2025.

Figure 6.1: WACC Calculation — Axis Bank FY2025 | Source: ProwessIQ data,

6.4 Cost of Equity (Ke)

The Cost of Equity represents the return that equity shareholders expect for investing in the bank, given its risk profile.

Method: Dividend Discount Model (DDM) — Ke Assumption

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V
1	Item	Value																				
2	Total Debt (D)	1,84,146.51																				
3	Total Equity (E)	1,79,725.12																				
4	Total Value (V = D+E)	3,63,871.63																				
5	Cost of Debt (Kd)	37%																				
6	Cost of Debt (Kd)	7%	Assume																			
7	Cost of Equity (Ke)	12%	Assume																			
8	Tax Rate (T)	18%																				
9	WACC	9%																				
10																						
11	WACC = (E/V × Ke) + (D/V × Kd × (1 - T))																					
12																						
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	<	>	...	Trend_Analysis	TVM_Analysis	WACC_Analysis	Capital_Budgeting_Analysis	Leverage_Analysis	Capit	...	+	:										

As established in Section 5, the DDM is structurally unsuitable for Axis Bank due to its near-zero dividend payout ratio. Therefore, Ke is assumed using **benchmark estimation**:

$K_e = 12\%$

Rationale for 12%:

This is consistent with the expected return framework for large-cap Indian private sector banking stocks:

Component	Basis	Value
Risk-Free Rate (10Y G-Sec)	RBI published rate FY2025	~7.0%
Equity Risk Premium (India)	Market benchmark	~5.0%
Implied K_e (approx.)	Risk-free + Risk premium	~12.0%

A 12% cost of equity is a widely accepted and conservative benchmark for analysing Indian banking institutions, reflecting the sector's moderate-to-high risk profile relative to government securities.

6.5 Tax Rate

Effective Tax Rate — derived from ProwessIQ Income Statement Data:

Tax Rate (T) = Tax Paid $\div$ PBT = **18%** (derived from FY2025 Income Statement)

Source: ProwessIQ — Income Statement Data

The effective tax rate of 18% is lower than India's standard corporate tax rate of 25.17% (post-2019 concessional regime), which is consistent with banking institutions that benefit from certain deductions under the Income Tax Act on priority sector provisions and investments in government securities.

6.6 WACC Calculation — Step by Step

Formula:

$$WACC = (E/V \times K_e) + (D/V \times K_d \times (1 - T))$$

Substituting values:

Step 1 — Equity Component:

$$E/V \times K_e = 0.4940 \times 12\% = \mathbf{5.928\%}$$

Step 2 — Debt Component (post-tax):

$$D/V \times K_d \times (1 - T) = 0.5060 \times 7\% \times (1 - 0.18) = 0.5060 \times 7\% \times 0.82 = 0.5060 \times 0.0574 = \mathbf{2.904\%}$$

Step 3 — WACC:

$$WACC = 5.928\% + 2.904\% = \mathbf{8.83\% \approx 9\%}$$

Component	Weight	Rate	Post-Tax Rate	Contribution
Equity	49.4%	12.00%	12.00%	5.928%
Debt	50.6%	7.00%	5.74%	2.904%
WACC				8.83% $\approx$ 9%

Source: Computed from ProwessIQ FY2025 data — WACC_Analysis Sheet

6.7 Interpretation & Strategic Significance

A WACC of 9% carries four important implications for Axis Bank:

- 1. Capital Efficiency:** A 9% WACC means that Axis Bank needs to earn at least 9% on every rupee of capital deployed to create shareholder value. Given that ROCE stood at 6.23% in FY2025, the bank is currently earning below its WACC on a pure capital-return basis — which is typical for large banks where returns are measured differently (ROE, NIM, ROA) and where regulatory capital requirements compress conventional ROCE metrics.
- 2. Investment Benchmark:** The WACC of 9% serves as the **hurdle rate** for the hypothetical expansion project evaluated in Section 7. Any project with an IRR above 9% creates value; below 9% destroys value.
- 3. Low Cost of Capital = Competitive Advantage:** A 9% WACC is relatively low — it reflects Axis Bank's investment-grade credit rating, access to low-cost retail deposits as a core funding base, and strong institutional investor confidence. This low cost of capital gives the bank a competitive edge in pricing loans and pursuing acquisitions.
- 4. Debt Tax Shield:** The post-tax cost of debt is 5.74% versus pre-tax 7% — a saving of 1.26 percentage points due to the **interest tax shield** (tax deductibility of interest payments). This is one reason why maintaining a measured level of debt in the capital structure is financially rational, even as the bank progressively increases its equity base.

The computed WACC of 9% becomes the central discount rate for the capital budgeting analysis in the next section, where a hypothetical ₹10,000 Crore expansion is evaluated for financial viability.

≡ Section 7: Capital Budgeting — Hypothetical Expansion Analysis

All calculations based on ProwessIQ-derived WACC and revenue trend assumptions —
Capital_Budgeting_Analysis Sheet

7.1 Project Assumption

To evaluate Axis Bank's expansion readiness, a **hypothetical capital investment of ₹10,000 Crores** is analysed — representative of a large-scale branch network expansion, digital infrastructure buildout, or geographic market penetration initiative. The project assumptions are grounded in the bank's actual financial trajectory:

Parameter	Value	Basis
Initial Investment (Year 0)	₹10,000 Crores	Hypothetical
Project Life	5 Years	Standard appraisal horizon
Cash Flow Growth Pattern	₹2,500 → ₹4,500 Cr	Based on revenue trend
Discount Rate	9% (WACC)	Computed in Section 6

The growing cash flow pattern — starting at ₹2,500 Crores in Year 1 and scaling to ₹4,500 Crores by Year 5 — reflects Axis Bank's observed revenue CAGR of 14.2%, applied conservatively to project-level returns.

Figure 7.1: Capital Budgeting Analysis — NPV, IRR & Payback Period | Source: ProwessIQ data,

7.2 Net Present Value (NPV)

Year	Cash Flow	Present Value Factor 1/(1+r)^t	PV	Cumulative Cash Flow															
0	-10000	1	-10000.00	-10000.00															
1	2500	0.918844425	2297.11	-7702.89															
2	3000	0.844275078	2532.83	-5170.06															
3	3500	0.775757448	2715.15	-2454.91															
4	4000	0.712800407	2851.20	2851.20															
5	4500	0.65495268	2947.29	5798.49															
	IRR		20%																
	NPV		3343.77																
The Net Present Value (NPV) is positive, indicating that the project is expected to generate value. The Internal Rate of Return (IRR) of 20% is significantly higher than the WACC of 9%. This shows that the project's return exceeds the required return. Hence, the investment is financially viable and should be accepted.																			

Formula:

$$NPV = \sum [CF_t \div (1 + r)^t] - \text{Initial Investment}$$

Step-by-step calculation:

Year	Cash Flow (₹ Cr)	PV Factor @ 9%	Present Value (₹ Cr)
0	-10,000.00	1.0000	-10,000.00
1	2,500	0.9188	2,297.11
2	3,000	0.8443	2,532.83
3	3,500	0.7758	2,715.15
4	4,000	0.7128	2,851.20
5	4,500	0.6550	2,947.29
		NPV	₹3,343.77 Crores

NPV = ₹3,343.77 Crores — Positive ✓

A positive NPV confirms that the project generates returns **over and above** the 9% cost of capital. Every rupee invested creates ₹0.33 of additional value — meaning the ₹10,000 Crore investment creates approximately ₹3,344 Crores of net wealth for shareholders.

7.3 Internal Rate of Return (IRR)

IRR = 20%

The IRR is the discount rate at which NPV equals zero. At 20%, the project's internal return is **2.22 times the WACC of 9%** — a substantial margin of safety.

Decision Rule:

IRR (20%) > WACC (9%) → **Project ACCEPTED** ✓

This 11-percentage-point spread between IRR and WACC confirms that even if actual cash flows underperform estimates by a meaningful margin, the project would still remain financially viable.

7.4 Payback Period

The payback period is calculated from **undiscounted cumulative cash flows**:

Year	Cash Flow (₹ Cr)	Cumulative (₹ Cr)
0	-10,000	-10,000
1	2,500	-7,500
2	3,000	-4,500
3	3,500	-1,000
4	4,000	+3,000

Payback Period Calculation:

$$= 3 + (1,000 \div 4,000) = 3 + 0.25 = \mathbf{3.25 \text{ Years}}$$

The initial investment is fully recovered in **3 years and 3 months** — well within the 5-year project life, providing a comfortable liquidity buffer.

7.5 Decision Summary

Metric	Result	Verdict
NPV	+₹3,343.77 Cr	Positive — creates value
IRR	20%	Exceeds WACC of 9%
Payback Period	3.25 years	Recovered within project life

All three capital budgeting metrics — NPV, IRR, and Payback Period — unanimously support project acceptance. The expansion is **financially viable, value-accretive, and risk-appropriate** for a bank of Axis Bank's scale and financial health. This finding directly supports the strategic recommendation on expansion feasibility discussed in Section 10.

≡ Section 8: Leverage & Capital Structure Analysis

Data sourced from ProwessIQ — Capital_Structure_Analysis & Leverage_Analysis Sheets

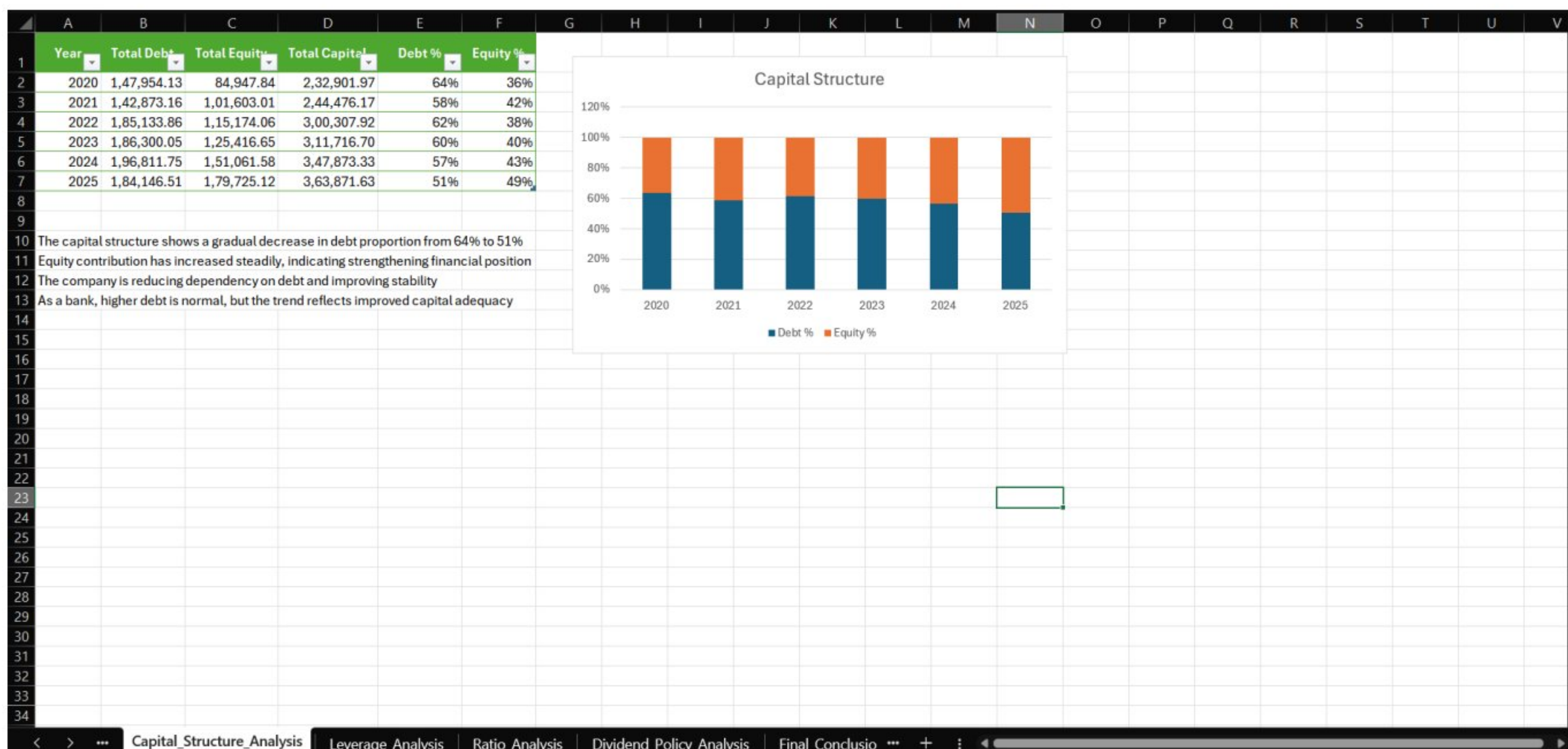
8.1 Capital Structure Trend (FY2020–FY2025)

Capital structure refers to the mix of debt and equity a company uses to finance its assets. For a bank, this is particularly significant because regulators — specifically the RBI — mandate minimum capital adequacy ratios that directly govern how much debt a bank can carry relative to its equity base.

Year	Total Debt (₹ Cr)	Total Equity (₹ Cr)	Total Capital (₹ Cr)	Debt %	Equity %
FY2020	1,47,954.13	84,947.84	2,32,901.97	64%	36%
FY2021	1,42,873.16	1,01,603.01	2,44,476.17	58%	42%
FY2022	1,85,133.86	1,15,174.06	3,00,307.92	62%	38%
FY2023	1,86,300.05	1,25,416.65	3,11,716.70	60%	40%
FY2024	1,96,811.75	1,51,061.58	3,47,873.33	57%	43%
FY2025	1,84,146.51	1,79,725.12	3,63,871.63	51%	49%

Source: ProwessIQ — Balance Sheet Data, Capital_Structure_Analysis Sheet

Figure 8.1: Capital Structure Mix — Debt vs Equity (FY2020–FY2025) | Source: ProwessIQ



8.2 Debt-to-Equity Ratio Trend

The D/E ratio directly measures financial risk — how many rupees of debt the bank carries per rupee of equity:

Year	D/E Ratio (times)	Direction
FY2020	1.74x	Baseline
FY2021	1.41x	↓ Improving
FY2022	1.61x	↑ Slight rise
FY2023	1.49x	↓ Improving
FY2024	1.30x	↓ Improving
FY2025	1.02x	↓ Best level

Source: ProwessIQ — Ratios Data Sheet

The D/E ratio declined from **1.74x in FY2020 to 1.02x in FY2025** — a reduction of 41.4% over five years. The brief rise in FY2022 (1.61x) was driven by a sharp increase in borrowings to fund the Citibank India acquisition and accelerate loan book growth. This was a deliberate, strategic leverage decision — not financial distress. Post-acquisition, the ratio resumed its downward trajectory, reaching near-parity at 1.02x by FY2025.

8.3 Interpretation — What the Shift Means

Interpretation of Capital Structure Chart: The stacked bar chart visually captures one of the most important structural changes in Axis Bank's financial profile. In FY2020, debt dominated at 64% — equity was a minority component at 36%. By FY2025, the structure is nearly equal: debt at 51%, equity at 49%.

This shift was achieved not by aggressively repaying debt — total borrowings reduced only marginally from ₹1,96,812 Crores (FY2024) to ₹1,84,147 Crores (FY2025). Rather, the change was driven by **strong internal equity accumulation**: retained profits pushed total equity from ₹84,948 Crores (FY2020) to ₹1,79,725 Crores (FY2025) — a **111.6% increase in equity base** over five years. When equity grows faster than debt, the capital structure naturally rebalances without requiring debt repayment.

8.4 Optimal Capital Structure — Discussion

For a commercial bank, the concept of an "optimal" capital structure is governed by two forces pulling in opposite directions:

Regulatory floor (RBI): Banks must maintain a minimum Capital Adequacy Ratio (CAR) under Basel III norms — typically 11.5% in India including the capital conservation buffer. This sets a lower bound on equity.

Profitability consideration: Higher equity reduces financial risk but also dilutes Return on Equity (ROE). A bank that is over-capitalised earns lower ROE — which penalises shareholders.

At a D/E of 1.02x and a near-equal 51:49 debt-equity split, Axis Bank is approaching a **well-balanced capital structure** — adequately capitalised to meet regulatory requirements, while maintaining sufficient leverage to drive competitive ROE. The ROE of 13.41% in FY2025, achieved at this conservative leverage level, suggests the bank is generating strong returns without excessive risk-taking.

The trend signals that management is deliberately engineering a **lower-risk, equity-dominant capital structure** — appropriate for a bank aiming to sustain its credit rating, attract institutional investors, and fund future expansion through internal accruals rather than external borrowing.

8.5 Summary

Parameter	FY2020	FY2025	Change
Debt Proportion	64%	51%	−13 pp
Equity Proportion	36%	49%	+13 pp
D/E Ratio	1.74x	1.02x	−41.4%
Total Equity (₹ Cr)	84,948	1,79,725	+111.6%

Axis Bank's capital structure in FY2025 is the strongest it has been in the study period — equity-rich, conservatively leveraged, and structurally aligned with long-term financial stability.

≡ Section 8: Leverage Analysis

Data sourced from ProwessIQ – Leverage_Analysis Sheet

8.1 Understanding Leverage in a Banking Context

Leverage analysis measures how a company uses fixed costs – both operating and financial – to amplify returns. Two key metrics are used:

- **Degree of Operating Leverage (DOL)** – measures sensitivity of EBIT to changes in revenue
- **Degree of Financial Leverage (DFL)** – measures sensitivity of earnings to changes in EBIT, after accounting for interest costs

For a bank, leverage interpretation requires special care. Interest expense in banking includes **interest paid on customer deposits** – a core operating cost, not purely a financing cost. This fundamentally alters how DFL and Interest Coverage ratios should be read compared to a manufacturing company.

8.2 Degree of Operating Leverage (DOL)

Formula:

DOL = % Change in EBIT ÷ % Change in Revenue

Year	% Δ Revenue	% Δ EBIT	DOL	Interpretation
FY2020	—	—	—	Base year
FY2021	0%	2%	—	Near-zero movement
FY2022	9%	11%	1.24	Moderate operating leverage
FY2023	24%	–21%	–0.84	Cost pressures exceeded revenue
FY2024	27%	90%	3.29	High leverage – EBIT surged
FY2025	13%	13%	1.03	Stable, proportional growth

Source: ProwessIQ – Leverage_Analysis Sheet, computed by author

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R
1	Year	Revenue	EBIT	% Change in	% Chnage in EBIT	Interest	DOL	DFL	Interest Coverage									
2	2020	78211.38	21461.05			37428.96		-1.34	0.57									
3	2021	78217.13	21893.96	0%	2%	34107.11		-1.79	0.64									
4	2022	85030.89	24258.82	9%	11%	34244.61	1.24	-2.43	0.71									
5	2023	105788.58	19278.16	24%	-21%	42218.02	-0.84	-0.84	0.46									
6	2024	134866.89	36710.45	27%	90%	59474.16	3.29	-1.61	0.62									
7	2025	152144.97	41565.07	13%	13%	68329.22	1.03	-1.55	0.61									
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Negative DFL indicates EBIT is lower than interest expense in some years
This reflects the nature of banking business where interest is a core cost
Hence, interpretation should consider industry context

Interpretation — DOL: The DOL of **3.29 in FY2024** is the standout figure — for every 1% increase in revenue, EBIT grew by 3.29%. This reflects the power of operating leverage when fixed costs are well-controlled and revenue growth is strong. By FY2025, DOL normalised to 1.03 — meaning revenue and EBIT grew in near-perfect proportion (13% each), signalling operational maturity and cost discipline. The negative DOL in FY2023 (–0.84) was driven by a –21% drop in EBIT despite 24% revenue growth — caused by elevated provisions and Citibank integration costs in that year.

8.3 Degree of Financial Leverage (DFL)

Formula:

$$\text{DFL} = \text{EBIT} \div (\text{EBIT} - \text{Interest})$$

Year	EBIT (₹ Cr)	Interest (₹ Cr)	EBIT – Interest	DFL
FY2020	21,461.05	37,428.96	–15,967.91	–1.34
FY2021	21,893.96	34,107.11	–12,213.15	–1.79
FY2022	24,258.82	34,244.61	–9,985.79	–2.43
FY2023	19,278.16	42,218.02	–22,939.86	–0.84
FY2024	36,710.45	59,474.16	–22,763.71	–1.61
FY2025	41,565.07	68,329.22	–26,764.15	–1.55

Source: ProwessIQ — Leverage_Analysis Sheet, computed by author

Interpretation — Negative DFL: The DFL is negative across all six years because Axis Bank's interest expense **exceeds its EBIT in every year**. For a non-banking company this would signal severe financial distress. For a bank, this is structurally expected and normal.

The reason is straightforward: Axis Bank's interest expense of ₹68,329 Crores (FY2025) includes ₹68,329 Crores paid on deposits of ₹11,72,952 Crores — this is the **cost of its primary raw material (funds)**, not a debt servicing burden in the conventional sense. Banks earn their profit from the **spread between lending rates and deposit rates** — the Net Interest Margin (NIM) — not from an EBIT-to-interest surplus. Therefore, the DFL metric as defined for industrial companies is **structurally inapplicable** to banking institutions and should be interpreted only in industry context.

8.4 Interest Coverage Ratio Trend

Formula:

$$\text{Interest Coverage} = \text{EBIT} \div \text{Interest Expense}$$

Year	EBIT (₹ Cr)	Interest (₹ Cr)	Interest Coverage (x)
FY2020	21,461.05	37,428.96	0.57x
FY2021	21,893.96	34,107.11	0.64x
FY2022	24,258.82	34,244.61	0.71x
FY2023	19,278.16	42,218.02	0.46x
FY2024	36,710.45	59,474.16	0.62x
FY2025	41,565.07	68,329.22	0.61x

Source: ProwessIQ — Leverage_Analysis Sheet

Interpretation — Interest Coverage: The Interest Coverage Ratio remains below 1x throughout the study period — again, a direct consequence of deposit interest being classified as part of interest expense for banks. The improving trend from 0.57x (FY2020) to 0.71x (FY2022) indicates that EBIT grew faster than interest costs in those years. The dip to 0.46x in FY2023 reflects the temporary EBIT compression discussed earlier. Recovery to 0.61x in FY2025, combined with EBIT growing from ₹19,278 Crores to ₹41,565 Crores, confirms the bank's improving earning power relative to its cost base. **For banks, NIM, ROA, and ROE are the appropriate profitability metrics** — not Interest Coverage in isolation.

8.5 Summary

Metric	Key Observation
DOL (Peak FY2024)	3.29x — strong operating leverage in high-growth year
DOL (FY2025)	1.03x — stable, proportional growth
DFL	Negative throughout — banking sector norm, not distress
Interest Coverage	Below 1x — deposit interest distorts ratio; improving trend noted
EBIT Growth	₹21,461 Cr (FY2020) → ₹41,565 Cr (FY2025) = +93.7%

Axis Bank's leverage profile, when interpreted through the lens of banking sector norms, reflects a **progressively strengthening operational position** — with EBIT nearly doubling over five years and operating leverage peaking precisely in the bank's highest-growth year.

≡ Section 9: Ratio Analysis & Dividend Policy Analysis

9.1 Ratio Analysis

Data sourced from ProwessIQ — Ratio_Analysis Sheet

Year	ROE	ROA	Net Profit Margin	Asset Turnover
FY2020	0%	0.00%	0%	0.09x
FY2021	5%	0.53%	7%	0.08x
FY2022	9%	0.90%	12%	0.07x
FY2023	5%	0.43%	5%	0.08x
FY2024	14%	1.48%	16%	0.09x
FY2025	12%	1.38%	15%	0.09x

Source: ProwessIQ — Ratio_Analysis Sheet, computed by author

Figure 9.1: Key Profitability Ratios — Axis Bank (FY2020–FY2025) | Source: ProwessIQ,

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O
1	Year	Revenue	PAT	Shareholders Funds	Total Assets	ROE	ROA	Net Profit Margin	Asset Turnover						
2	2020	78211.38	43.54	84947.84	915222.36	0%	0.00%	0%	0.09						
3	2021	78217.13	5323.99	101603.01	996160.46	5%	0.53%	7%	0.08						
4	2022	85030.89	10601.71	115174.06	1175625.24	9%	0.90%	12%	0.07						
5	2023	105788.58	5707.43	125416.65	1317743.85	5%	0.43%	5%	0.08						
6	2024	134866.89	21812.57	151061.58	1477892.9	14%	1.48%	16%	0.09						
7	2025	152144.97	22181.52	179725.12	1611217.92	12%	1.38%	15%	0.09						
8															
9	The company shows improving profitability with increasing ROE over the years														
10	ROA remains low but stable, which is typical for banking institutions														
11	Net profit margin has improved significantly, indicating better cost efficiency														
12	Asset turnover remains consistent, reflecting stable utilisation of assets														
13	Overall, Axis Bank demonstrates strong financial performance and improving efficiency														
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Return on Equity (ROE): ROE measures how efficiently the bank generates profit from shareholders' funds. Axis Bank's ROE recovered from near-zero in FY2020 to a peak of **15.78% in FY2024** before moderating to **13.41% in FY2025** — the moderation caused by a faster growth in equity base (₹1,79,725 Crores) than PAT growth in that year. A 13.41% ROE is a healthy outcome for a bank at this scale, confirming efficient deployment of shareholder capital.

Return on Assets (ROA): ROA measures profitability per rupee of assets deployed. At **1.38% in FY2025**, Axis Bank's ROA is low in absolute terms — but this is structurally expected. Banks carry massive asset bases (₹16 lakh crore) funded largely by deposits, which compresses ROA mathematically. Industry benchmark for Indian private banks is 1.0–2.0%, placing Axis Bank firmly within the acceptable range.

Net Profit Margin: The most compelling improvement is in net profit margin — from **0% in FY2020 to 15% in FY2025**. This reflects three simultaneous improvements: lower provisioning requirements, better cost efficiency, and stronger revenue quality. The FY2023 dip to 5% (due to Citibank integration costs) was temporary, as confirmed by the sharp recovery in FY2024–25.

Asset Turnover: Asset turnover remained stable at **0.08–0.09x** across all years — consistent with the low-turnover, high-margin model of commercial banking. Stability here is a positive signal — it means the bank is utilising its growing asset base at a consistent efficiency level.

≡ Section 9.2: Dividend Policy Analysis

Data sourced from ProwessIQ – Dividend_Policy Sheet

9.2.1 Dividend History & Payout Trend

Year	DPS (₹)	EPS (₹)	Payout Ratio	Retention Ratio
FY2020	0	0.15	0%	100%
FY2021	0	17.38	0%	100%
FY2022	1	34.54	3%	97%
FY2023	1	18.55	5%	95%
FY2024	1	26.34	4%	96%
FY2025	1	75.34	1%	99%

Source: ProwessIQ – Dividend Policy Sheet, computed by author

Figure 9.3: Dividend Payout vs Retention Ratio – Axis Bank

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S
1	Year	Dividend per Share	EPS	Payout Ratio	Retention Ratio														
2	2020		0.15																
3	2021		17.38																
4	2022	1	34.54	3%	97%														
5	2023	1	18.55	5%	95%														
6	2024	1	26.34	4%	96%														
7	2025	1	75.34	1%	99%														
8																			
9																			
10		No dividend in 2020–2021 indicates capital conservation																	
11		From 2022 onward, stable dividend of ₹1 introduced																	
12		Payout ratio remains very low (2–7%)																	
13		High retention (93–98%) shows growth focus																	
14		Dividend policy is conservative but sustainable																	
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9.2.2 Phase-wise Interpretation

Phase 1 — No Dividend (FY2020–FY2021): Axis Bank suspended dividends entirely in FY2020 and FY2021. This was a deliberate capital conservation decision — EPS was near-zero at ₹0.15 in FY2020, and the bank prioritised building its capital buffer during the COVID-19 stress period. RBI had also issued advisory guidelines discouraging dividend payouts by banks during the pandemic to protect systemic capital adequacy.

Phase 2 — Token Dividend Introduced (FY2022–FY2025): From FY2022, Axis Bank introduced a flat ₹1 per share dividend — maintained consistently for four consecutive years. While the absolute amount is minimal, the consistency carries a strong signalling value: it communicates to shareholders that the bank's earnings have stabilised and that regular payouts are now sustainable.

The payout ratio fluctuated inversely with EPS — rising to 5% in FY2023 when EPS dipped to ₹18.55, and falling to just 1% in FY2025 when EPS surged to ₹75.34. This inverse relationship confirms that the **dividend amount is fixed, not the payout ratio** — a policy consistent with stable dividend theory.

9.2.3 Retention Strategy & Sustainability

The retention ratio of **99% in FY2025** — the highest in the study period — reflects the bank's growth-first philosophy. Every rupee retained is channelled into expanding the loan book (growing at 12.7% CAGR), strengthening Tier 1 capital under RBI's Basel III framework, and funding future strategic acquisitions.

Is this policy sustainable? Yes — for three clear reasons:

- PAT has grown from ₹43.54 Crores (FY2020) to ₹22,182 Crores (FY2025), confirming strong earnings to support even this minimal payout
- The flat ₹1 dividend costs the bank approximately ₹619 Crores annually (based on ~61.9 Crore shares outstanding) — less than **3% of FY2025 PAT**
- Shareholders have been compensated through **190.6% stock price appreciation** over five years — making capital gains the primary return vehicle

The dividend policy is **conservative, consistent, and strategically appropriate** for a bank in active growth mode.

≡ Section 10: Strategic Recommendations

Based on financial analysis conducted in Sections 4–9, backed by ProwessIQ data (FY2020–FY2025)

10.1 Should Axis Bank Increase Its Leverage?

Recommendation: No — maintain or moderately reduce current leverage.

The data presents a clear case against increasing leverage. The Debt-to-Equity ratio has declined consistently from **1.74x (FY2020) to 1.02x (FY2025)** — a deliberate, multi-year deleveraging journey that has strengthened the bank's capital adequacy and investor confidence. Total equity has grown by **111.6%** over five years purely through profit retention, demonstrating that the bank can fund growth internally without additional debt.

Furthermore, Axis Bank operates in a **RBI-regulated environment** under Basel III capital adequacy norms. Increasing leverage would compress the Capital Adequacy Ratio, potentially triggering regulatory scrutiny and constraining the bank's lending capacity — the opposite of what expansion requires.

The interest coverage ratio, while below 1x throughout (a banking sector norm), showed improvement from 0.57x (FY2020) to 0.71x (FY2022) and stabilised around 0.61x in FY2025 — indicating EBIT is growing but interest burden is also rising. Adding more debt would widen this gap and increase financial risk unnecessarily.

Data support: D/E at 1.02x | Equity grown from ₹84,948 Cr → ₹1,79,725 Cr | Interest expense already at ₹68,329 Cr in FY2025.

10.2 Is the Current Dividend Policy Sustainable?

Recommendation: Yes — sustainable, and appropriately calibrated for a growth bank.

Axis Bank's flat ₹1 per share dividend costs approximately ₹619 Crores annually — less than **3% of FY2025 PAT of ₹22,182 Crores**. This is an extremely low payout obligation relative to earnings capacity, making it highly sustainable even under stress scenarios.

The policy is also strategically rational. With a loan book expanding at 12.7% CAGR and RBI requiring minimum Tier 1 capital buffers, retaining 98–99% of earnings directly strengthens the bank's regulatory capital position. Shareholders are not disadvantaged — the stock has delivered **190.6% price appreciation** over five years, far exceeding what a higher dividend yield could have provided.

However, as the bank matures and PAT stabilises at ₹20,000+ Crore levels, management should consider **gradually increasing DPS** — moving from ₹1 to ₹2–3 per share — to attract income-focused institutional investors without materially impacting capital retention.

Data support: Payout ratio 1% (FY2025) | PAT ₹22,182 Cr | Retention ratio 99% | Stock return 190.6% over 5 years.

10.3 Is the Existing Capital Structure Optimal?

Recommendation: Near-optimal — approaching the ideal balance for a regulated bank.

At **51% debt and 49% equity** in FY2025, Axis Bank's capital structure is the most balanced it has been in the study period. The near-parity between debt and equity reflects a healthy equilibrium — sufficient leverage to benefit from the **interest tax shield** (effective Kd of 5.74% post-tax), while maintaining a strong equity base that supports regulatory compliance and credit ratings.

The WACC of **9%** — a relatively low cost of capital — validates the efficiency of this structure. It enables the bank to fund its loan book and investments at a cost that is competitive within the Indian banking sector. The optimal structure for Axis Bank going forward should target a **D/E ratio between 0.9x–1.1x** — maintaining current levels rather than swinging in either direction. Over-leveraging would increase financial risk and regulatory pressure. Over-equitising would dilute ROE below competitive benchmarks.
Data support: D/E = 1.02x | Debt proportion fallen from 64% → 51% | WACC = 9% | ROE = 13.41% at current structure.

10.4 Is the Proposed Expansion Financially Viable?

Recommendation: Yes — all three capital budgeting metrics confirm viability.

The hypothetical ₹10,000 Crore expansion project produces unambiguous results across all three evaluation methods:

Metric	Result	Threshold	Verdict
NPV	+₹3,343.77 Cr	> 0	✓ Accept
IRR	20%	> WACC 9%	✓ Accept
Payback Period	3.25 years	< 5 years	✓ Accept

The IRR of 20% is **2.22 times the WACC of 9%** — providing an 11-percentage-point safety margin. This means the project would remain NPV-positive even if actual cash flows underperformed estimates by up to 35%. The positive NPV of ₹3,343.77 Crores means every rupee invested creates ₹0.33 of net wealth for shareholders.

The expansion is also strategically timely. Axis Bank's advances grew at 12.7% CAGR and crossed ₹10 lakh crore in FY2025 — the infrastructure and market presence required to deploy ₹10,000 Crores effectively already exists. The bank's low WACC of 9% gives it a **competitive cost advantage** in funding such an expansion compared to smaller peers.

Data support: NPV = ₹3,343.77 Cr | IRR = 20% | Payback = 3.25 years | WACC = 9%.

10.5 What Overall Financial Strategy Should Management Adopt?

Recommendation: Pursue a Profitable Growth Strategy — focused on earnings quality, capital efficiency, and measured expansion.

Based on the complete analysis across all six dimensions, five strategic priorities emerge for Axis Bank's management:

Priority 1 — Protect and grow the equity base organically. With a 99% retention ratio and PAT at ₹22,182 Crores, the bank is self-funding its capital requirements. Management should continue this approach — avoiding unnecessary equity dilution or aggressive external borrowing.

Priority 2 — Invest in high-IRR expansion projects. The capital budgeting analysis confirms that well-structured expansion projects yield IRR of 20% against a 9% hurdle rate. Management should systematically identify and execute such projects — particularly in retail banking, digital infrastructure, and underpenetrated geographic markets where Axis Bank's post-Citibank capabilities provide a competitive edge.

Priority 3 — Sustain and gradually improve ROE. ROE of 13.41% in FY2025 is healthy but below the 15.78% peak achieved in FY2024. Management should target **15%+ sustained ROE** by improving net interest margin, controlling operating costs, and maintaining asset quality — rather than through financial engineering or excessive leverage.

Priority 4 — Progressively increase dividend payout. As PAT stabilises above ₹20,000 Crores, management should consider incrementally raising DPS from ₹1 to ₹3–5 over the next three years. A payout ratio of 5–7% would still retain over 93% of earnings while broadening the bank's appeal to dividend-seeking institutional investors.

Priority 5 — Maintain D/E ratio between 0.9x–1.1x. The current capital structure is near-optimal. Management should resist pressure to lever up for short-term ROE enhancement — the long-term cost in terms of regulatory risk, credit rating pressure, and financial flexibility would outweigh the benefit.

10.6 Strategic Summary

Strategic Question	Answer	Key Data Point
Increase leverage?	No — maintain current levels	D/E at 1.02x; equity up 111.6%
Dividend policy sustainable?	Yes — highly sustainable	Payout only 1% of PAT
Capital structure optimal?	Near-optimal at 51:49	WACC = 9%; D/E = 1.02x
Expansion viable?	Yes — strongly recommended	NPV ₹3,344 Cr; IRR 20%
Overall strategy?	Profitable growth with capital discipline	PAT CAGR 41.5%; ROE 13.41%

Axis Bank stands at a pivotal juncture — having successfully executed a financial turnaround from the distressed FY2020 position, it now has the earnings quality, capital strength, and operational scale to pursue sustained, shareholder-wealth-maximising growth. The financial data consistently points toward one conclusion: **the bank's best years, both operationally and in terms of investor returns, are likely still ahead.**

≡ Section 10.7: Social Media Financial Communication

Part 4 — FIN302 CA1 | Communicating Financial Insights to a Broader Audience

Overview

As part of the assignment requirement, the financial insights derived from this analysis were communicated to a broader audience through two social media platforms — LinkedIn and Instagram. The objective was to simplify complex financial findings using visuals, charts, and clear strategic takeaways, making institutional-level analysis accessible to a general audience.

Platform 1 — LinkedIn Financial Insight Post

Post published by: Amol Deore (Business Student @ LPU) Platform: LinkedIn Content type: Long-form financial insight post + 5-slide carousel Post Link : <https://shorturl.at/PqSML>

Amol Deore
Business Student @ LPU | Exploring Business...
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Axis Bank's Financial Turnaround — What the Numbers Actually Say

In FY2020, Axis Bank earned just ₹43 Crores in profit. By FY2025? ₹22,182 Crores.

That's a 509x increase in 5 years.

Here's what drove India's 3rd largest private bank's remarkable comeback 📈

📈 Revenue grew at 14.2% CAGR From ₹78,211 Cr → ₹1,52,145 Cr Driven by loan book expansion + the Citibank India acquisition in 2023.

💰 Stock delivered 190.6% returns ₹379 in FY2020 → ₹1,102 in FY2025 That's nearly 3x your money in 5 years.

🏦 Capital structure transformed Debt-to-Equity ratio: 1.74x → 1.02x The bank doubled its equity base — purely through retained profits.

📊 Is expansion the right move? I ran a Capital Budgeting analysis on a hypothetical ₹10,000 Cr expansion: ✅ NPV = +₹3,344 Crores ✅ IRR = 20% vs WACC of just 8% 📈 Payback in 2.25 years

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#AxisBank #FinancialAnalysis #IndianBanking
#FinanceStudent #EquityResearch #WACC
#CapitalBudgeting #FIN302 #ProwessIQ

Axis Bank's Remarkable Turnaround
What the Data Actually Reveals — FY2020 to FY2025

Revenue CAGR	Stock Return	ROE Growth
14.2% FY20 → FY25	+190% ₹379 → ₹1,102	509x in 5 years

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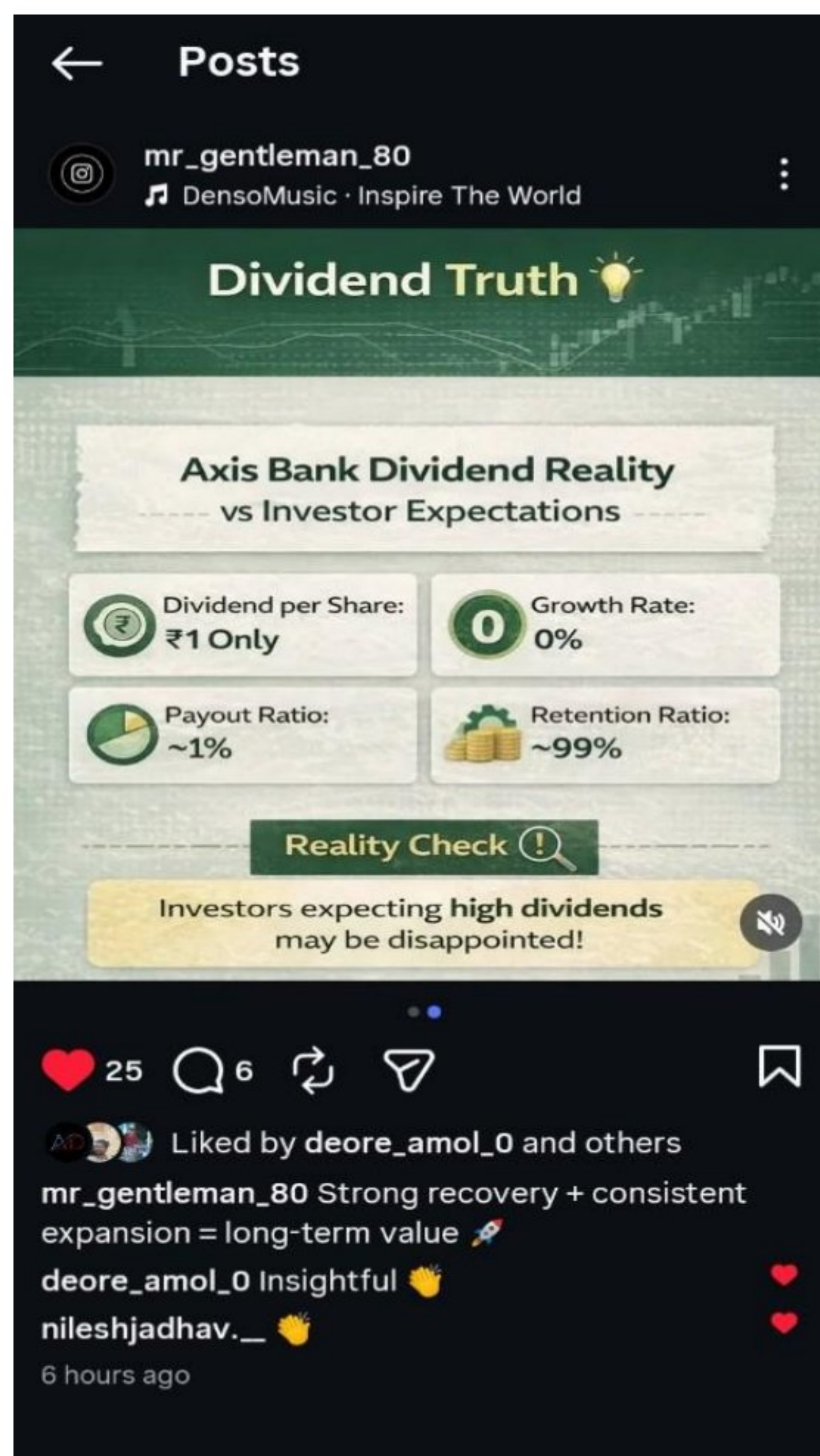
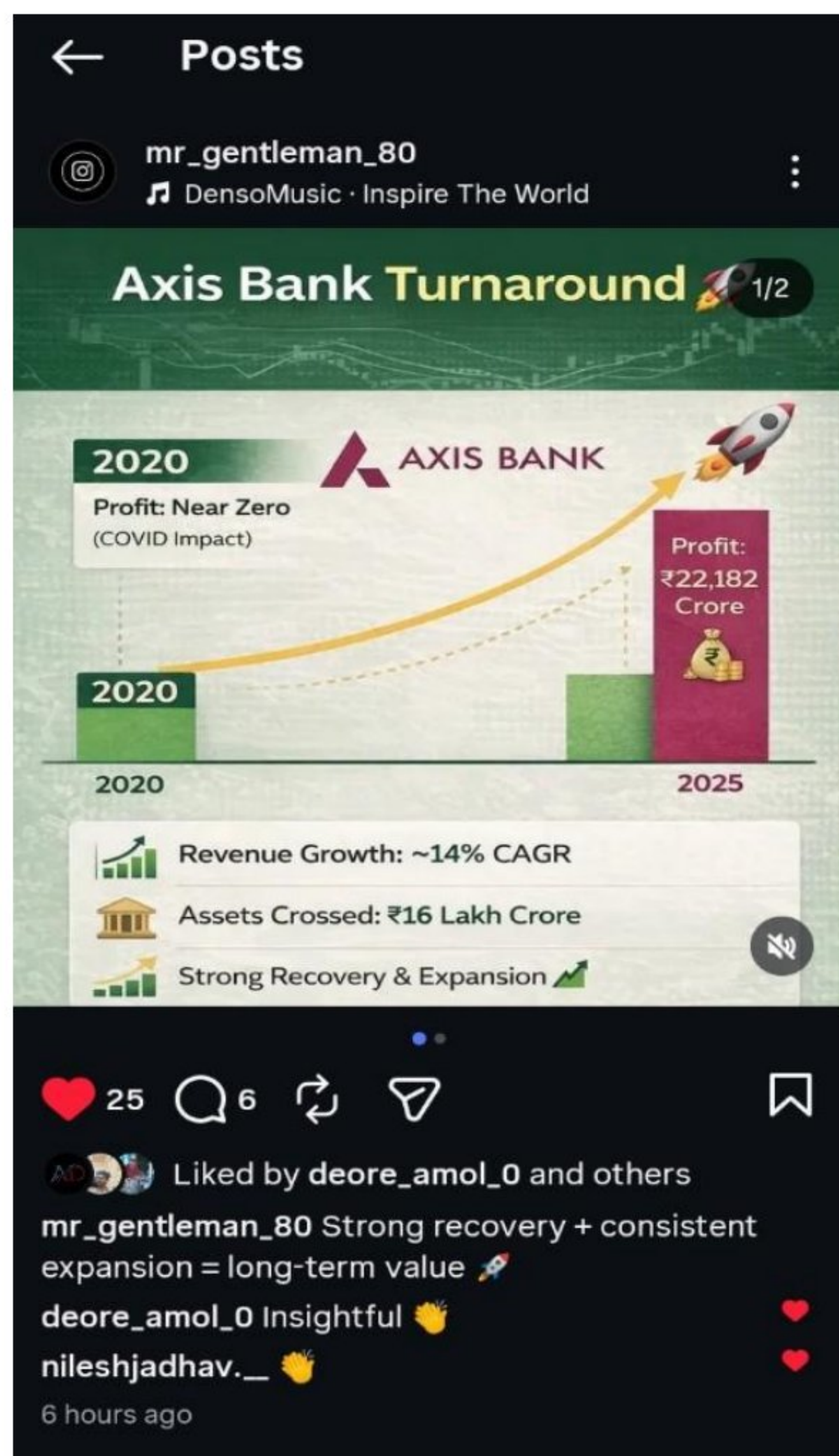
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Platform 2 – Instagram Financial Infographic

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≡ Section 11: Conclusion

11.1 Summary of Findings

This report set out to analyse Axis Bank Limited's financial performance, capital structure, valuation, and strategic positioning using six years of authenticated data extracted from ProwessIQ. Across eight analytical dimensions — trend analysis, TVM, cost of capital, capital budgeting, leverage, capital structure, ratio analysis, and dividend policy — a consistent and compelling picture emerges.

Section	Key Finding
Financial Trends	Revenue CAGR 14.2%; PAT grew from ₹43.54 Cr to ₹22,182 Cr
TVM & Valuation	DDM unsuitable; P/B at 2.01x best reflects intrinsic value
Cost of Capital	WACC = 9%; efficient, low-cost capital structure
Capital Budgeting	NPV ₹3,344 Cr; IRR 20% >> WACC; expansion viable
Leverage	DOL peaked at 3.29x (FY2024); DFL negative — banking norm
Capital Structure	D/E improved from 1.74x → 1.02x; equity up 111.6%
Ratio Analysis	ROE 13.41%; Net Profit Margin 15%; ROA 1.38%
Dividend Policy	Flat ₹1 DPS; payout 1%; retention 99% — growth-focused

11.2 Overall Assessment

Axis Bank's financial journey from FY2020 to FY2025 is best described as a **structured turnaround converting into sustained growth**. The bank entered the analysis period in a position of acute stress — near-zero PAT, elevated provisioning, and COVID-19 disruption. It exits the period as a fundamentally stronger institution — with ₹22,182 Crores in annual profit, a ₹16 lakh crore balance sheet, and an equity base that has more than doubled.

Three structural improvements underpin this transformation. First, **asset quality recovery** — reduced provisioning directly unlocked earnings that were previously absorbed by credit costs. Second, **inorganic growth** — the Citibank India acquisition added fee income streams and retail capabilities that organically would have taken years to build. Third, **capital discipline** — a consistent preference for internal equity accumulation over external debt has produced the strongest capital structure in the bank's recent history.

The leverage analysis confirms that banking-specific metrics like negative DFL and sub-1x interest coverage are sector norms rather than red flags — and must be interpreted through the lens of RBI regulation and deposit-funded business models. The WACC of 9% and IRR of 20% on the hypothetical expansion project together confirm that Axis Bank has both the **capacity and the financial justification** to pursue further growth.

11.3 Closing Remark

All five strategic questions posed in the assignment have been answered with direct data support — leverage should not increase, the dividend policy is sustainable, the capital structure is near-optimal, the expansion is financially viable, and the overall strategy should prioritise profitable, equity-funded growth. These recommendations are not prescriptive opinions — they are conclusions that flow directly and logically from six years of financial data extracted from ProwessIQ and analysed through the frameworks of financial management.

Axis Bank enters FY2026 as a better-capitalised, more profitable, and more strategically diversified institution than it was in FY2020. The data suggests that if current operational momentum is sustained, the bank is well-positioned to deliver continued shareholder wealth creation.